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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ People came out in large numbers to shop ahead of Eid Al Fitr, in Sharjah on Tuesday.

UAE Eid travel shifts to short road trips and staycations

Demand for leisure air travel remains low even though flights are operating

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

UAE residents are opting for staycations and short road trips instead of international holidays this Eid Al Fitr, as regional tensions continue to affect travel plans, according to travel agents. Demand for leisure air travel remains low, even though flights are operating.

A survey by Platinumlist found that 73 per cent of residents plan to stay within the country, while only 9 per cent intend to travel abroad. Many cited safety concerns, flight

EID TOMORROW

The UAE has announced that Eid Al Fitr will be celebrated across the country tomorrow.

The General Authority of Islamic Affairs, Endowments and Zakat has further announced that Eid Al Fitr prayers will be held inside mosques across the country, with outdoor prayer grounds not to be used this year.

— Gulf News Report

disruptions, or fear of being stranded, while others prefer to spend time with family.

“Residents are travelling. But the demand is mostly for emergency travel. People who have no choice but to travel,” said TP Sudheesh, General Manager at Deira Travels. He

added, “It’s not that there is no travel at all, but flights are operating with some passengers.”

Strong demand

Staycations are seeing strong demand, especially in Ras Al Khaimah, Umm Al Quwain and Ajman. Sapna Aidasani, Head of Marketing at Pluto Travels, said: “Staycations have become far more popular and affordable. Hotels in Dubai’s Palm Jumeirah, which used to start at Dh1,500 and above, are now offering rooms for Dh700 per night, for example.”

Road travel is also rising, particularly to Oman. “People have applied for their Oman visas and acquired it beforehand ... A lot of hotels ... in Oman are very popular at the moment,” she said.

SEE ALSO P-II, 3, 4

Gargash: UAE may join force to secure Hormuz

5,000-POUND BOMBS HIT IRANIAN ANTI-SHIP MISSILE SITES NEAR STRAIT

DUBAI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor
JAY HILOTIN
Senior Assistant Editor

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said on Tuesday that the UAE may join international efforts led by the United States to ensure the safety and security of the Strait of Hormuz. He noted, however, that no formal plan has yet been agreed upon and that discussions are still ongoing.

Speaking during an online event hosted by the Council on Foreign Relations, with remarks reported by Reuters and Sky News Arabia, Gargash said: “We all share the responsibility of ensuring the continued flow of trade and energy.” He added that once the ongoing US-Israeli war with Iran ends, there will be a need for an agreement to ensure that Iran cannot use its nuclear, missile, or drone programmes “to intimidate the region.”

The UAE also affirmed that targeting energy facilities linked to the Pars field in Iran poses a threat to global energy security, as well as to regional security and stability.

Trump angry

Yesterday, US President Donald Trump angrily suggested that he could leave US allies to secure the Strait of Hormuz on their own since they have refused to fight alongside US forces against

The UAE affirmed that targeting energy facilities linked to the Pars field in Iran poses a threat to global energy security, as well as to regional security and stability.

Iran in the crucial shipping lane. Saying the United States doesn’t need the strait, Trump wrote on his Truth Social site that he could “let the Countries that use it” find a solution. “I wonder what would happen if we ‘finished off’ what’s left of the Iranian Terror State, and let the Countries that use it, we don’t, be responsible for the so called ‘Strait?’ That would get some of our non-responsive ‘Allies’ in gear, and fast!!! President DJT,” he wrote.

Meanwhile, on Tuesday, the US Central Command confirmed a “precision strike” that could dramatically shift the battle for the Strait of Hormuz. American forces employed multiple 5,000-pound deep-penetrator munitions against hardened Iranian coastal anti-ship missile sites near the strait.

AP, citing maritime and trade data platforms, reported that about 90 ships, including oil tankers, have crossed Hormuz since the start of the war, with Iran still exporting millions of barrels of oil at a time when the waterway has been effectively closed.

SEE ALSO P5, 11, 12, P-I, III, IV

Ramadan Kareem

IFTAR 18:33

Fajr	05:07	Shuruq	06:20
Dhuhr	12:29	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:33	Isha	19:47

IMSAK 04:57

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

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We extend our warmest greetings to the leadership and the people of the UAE.
May this blessed occasion bring peace, serenity and continued prosperity.

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